

LET US READ

The Wooden Toy

Once there was a village circled by mountains and many big trees. It was the home to many wild animals, especially wild dogs. They used to hunt not only the animals in the forest but, also the domestic animals in the village. This affected the farmer who lived near the edge of the forest with his son the most.

Mugund was the son of the farmer. He was good at creating many things. Every day he went into the forest to collect dry wood. He used to make dolls using the dry wood. Mugund's art was very famous in the town. Children used to play with his dolls, mostly known as marapachi bommai.



Long ago, the wild animals hunted Mugund's mother. That incident made Mugund hate wild animals. In memory of his mother, he carved a wooden statue of his mother and prayed every day. One night, he woke to hear his mother's words, "Do your part in eradicating the use of plastics through your art because plastic is a great risk to the environment."

So, he started selling wooden toys at a cheap rate. He was also clever at making handicrafts. He learnt the art from his grandfather. In the beginning, he made dolls for children, using dry wood. Then, he was making statues of any photo that was shown to him.

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